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The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, clouds and some sun, not as cool, dry, high 47. **Tonight**, cloudy, a rain or snow shower, low 34. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, breezy, periodic snow, high 36. Weather map is on Page B6.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,802

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SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 21, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

JUSTICES REJECT TRUMP’S TARIFFS IN KEY BLOW TO HIS TRADE POLICY

U.S. Choking Oil Deliveries To Cuba Ports

Military Action Brings a Nation to Its Knees

**By JACK NICAS
and CHRISTIAAN TRIEBERT**

MEXICO CITY — Cuba is confronting the United States’ first effective blockade since the Cuban Missile Crisis and running out of fuel fast, pushing the country toward a humanitarian crisis and its government to the edge of collapse, according to a New York Times analysis of shipping data and satellite images.

Cuban tankers have hardly left the island’s shores for months. Oil-rich allies have halted shipments or declined to come to the rescue. The U.S. military has seized ships that have supported Cuba. And in recent days, vessels roaming the Caribbean Sea in search of fuel for Cuba have come up empty or been intercepted by the U.S. authorities.

Last week, a tanker linked to Cuba burned fuel for five days to get to the port in Curaçao but then left without cargo, according to ship-tracking data. Three days later, the U.S. Coast Guard intercepted a tanker full of Colombian fuel oil en route to Cuba that had gotten within 70 miles of the island, the data showed.

While President Trump has pledged to halt any oil headed to Cuba, the Trump administration has stopped short of calling its policy a blockade.

But it is functioning as one.

Mr. Trump signed an executive order last month threatening to impose tariffs on countries that provide oil to Cuba. That has succeeded at scaring other nations, like Mexico, into sitting on the sidelines despite their desire to help Cuba.

At the same time, the largest U.S. military presence in the Caribbean in decades is policing the waters around the island, fresh off its work blocking oil shipments to and from Venezuela ahead of the U.S. capture of the country’s leader, Nicolás Maduro, last month.

And, according to a U.S. official who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss operational

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ANNA ROSE LAYDEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES
President Trump on Friday called the justices who voted against him “very unpatriotic and disloyal.”

For G.O.P., a Voter ID Measure Is Only the Start

By ANNIE KARNI

WASHINGTON — The strict voter identification measure that Republicans have pushed through the House is just their opening salvo in a broader legislative effort aimed at keeping control of Congress this fall and helping to amplify the president’s false claims of mass voter fraud in the event that they lose.

The G.O.P.’s relentless focus on the bill and an even more restrictive measure making its way

Amplifying Fraud Fears to Retain Majorities

through the House — both of which face a steep uphill path to becoming law — is aimed chiefly at intensifying pressure within their own ranks to muscle through new voting restrictions and seek to reshape the electorate in their favor.

But it also allows Republicans

to hammer home President Trump’s falsehoods about widespread illegal voting, particularly by undocumented immigrants, helping them build a case, however groundless, that any Democratic victories in November will be a result of cheating.

“As President Trump told me last week, it really will save America,” Representative Tim Burchett, Republican of Tennessee, recently told a right-leaning media outlet in Florida, of the push to enact the measure that

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With a 6-3 Ruling, Independence Is Declared

By ADAM LIPTAK

WASHINGTON — Starting with the 2024 decision that gave President Trump substantial immunity from prosecution and continuing through a score of emergency orders provisionally greenlighting an array of his second-term initiatives, Mr. Trump has had an extraordinarily successful run before the Supreme Court.

That came to a sudden, jolting halt on Friday, when Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr., writing for six members of the court, roundly rejected Mr. Trump’s signature tariffs program. It was the Supreme Court’s first merits ruling — a final judgment on the lawfulness of an executive action — on an element of the administration’s second-term agenda. It amounted to a declaration of independence.

It also served as another in a series of clashes between the leaders of two branches of the federal government cut from very different cloth: the controlled, cerebral chief justice and the biting, brazen president.

It could make for an awkward evening Tuesday, when, if history is any guide, Chief Justice Roberts and several of his colleagues will attend Mr. Trump’s State of the Union address, sitting in their robes within eyesight of the president.

On Friday, Mr. Trump may have provided a preview of his remarks, saying at a news conference that he was ashamed of some of the justices — presumably the ones who voted against him. “They’re very unpatriotic and disloyal to our Constitution,” he said of those justices.

There is precedent for a presidential critique of a recent Supreme Court decision during the annual presidential speech. In 2010, President Barack Obama castigated the court for its decision in the Citizens United campaign finance case, which amplified the role of money in politics. Chief Justice Roberts’s expression suggested he did not enjoy the rebuke.

There was also an awkward moment last year after Mr. Trump addressed Congress. As

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President Berates Court, Vowing Workaround

By ANN E. MARIMOW

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court ruled on Friday that President Trump exceeded his authority when he imposed sweeping tariffs on imports from nearly every U.S. trading partner, a major setback for his administration’s second-term agenda.

The court’s 6-3 decision has significant implications for the U.S. economy, consumers and the president’s trade policy. The Trump administration had said that a loss at the Supreme Court could force the government to unwind trade deals with other countries and potentially pay hefty refunds to importers.

Mr. Trump is the first president to claim that a 1970s emergency statute, which does not mention the word “tariffs,” allowed him to unilaterally impose the duties without congressional approval.

Writing for the majority, Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. said that statute does not authorize the president to impose tariffs.

“The president asserts the extraordinary power to unilaterally impose tariffs of unlimited amount, duration and scope. In light of the breadth, history and constitutional context of that asserted authority, he must identify clear congressional authorization to exercise it,” the chief justice wrote.

Justices Clarence Thomas, Samuel A. Alito Jr. and Brett M. Kavanaugh dissented.

The decision on Friday left uncertain the extent to which those who paid tariffs might be able to obtain refunds, with Justice Kavanaugh warning that any refund process could be a substantial “mess.”

The United States “may be required to refund billions of dollars to importers who paid” the tariffs, he wrote, “even though some importers may have already passed on costs to consumers or others.”

The court’s ruling, backed by justices from across the ideological spectrum, was a rare and significant example in which the Supreme Court pushed back on Mr. Trump’s agenda. Since he returned to the White House, the court’s conservative majority had overwhelmingly issued emergency orders allowing the presi-

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Flowing Freely To a Disco Beat, And to the Gold

By GIA KOURLAS

I’m a dance critic, one who trained as a figure skater in my early teens. I am not a judge. But I do have enough insight to know that competition is the beast that makes figure skating and the discipline of ice dance such a messy and confusing mix of art and sport. Often, it seems like the idea of a performance is the last thing on a skater’s tense and troubled mind. It’s nerve-racking to watch them fight the ice instead of moving with it, but the ability to bring warmth to a hard, frozen surface is where artistry lives.

Alysa Liu, a rare artist on ice, skates to perform. Now 20, she came back to competitive skating

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VINCENT ALBAN/THE NEW YORK TIMES
Out of retirement, Alysa Liu won gold in figure skating on Thursday with a renewed focus on joy.

Detection Test for Cancer Fails A Closely Watched Clinical Trial

By REBECCA ROBBINS and GINA KOLATA

A promising blood test aimed at early detection of cancer failed to reduce late-stage cancer diagnoses in a major clinical trial, the test’s maker, Grail, announced on Thursday.

The results cast doubt on a developing field of screening for diseases that has generated enormous hopes and investment. The goal of the blood tests is to save and extend lives by detecting cancers when they can be more easily and successfully treated.

Grail’s test, known as Galleri, looks for minuscule shards of cancer DNA in the blood and for more than 50 types of cancer, according to the company. The test was briefly featured in a Super Bowl ad this month.

Galleri has been sold in the United States since 2021 and costs \$949. Even though the blood test is not yet approved by the Food and Drug Administration, the com-

pany markets it under a regulatory loophole that permits sales of certain tests without review. Very few insurers cover the test, so most people pay for it out of pocket. Grail said it had sold nearly half a million of the tests so far, including more than 185,000 last year.

The company lobbied heavily for the U.S. government to cover the test under Medicare. The spending package passed by Congress and signed into law by President Trump earlier this month authorized Medicare to cover cancer detection tests, and Galleri could be among those that qualify to receive the government’s approval.

Demand for tests to detect cancer and other diseases has grown in recent years, reflected by a surge of interest among companies and consumers. Exact Sci-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Upheaval in Ex-Prince’s Arrest
King Charles III’s family, long rocked by infighting, is facing a grave threat to its moral authority. **PAGE A9**

‘King of Banned Films’
Acclaimed overseas for defying censors, Lou Ye is more interested in reaching Chinese audiences. **PAGE A4**



BUSINESS B1-5

A Slowdown to End 2025
The U.S.’s gross domestic product expanded at only a 1.4 percent annual rate in the last quarter, hit by the effects of the government shutdown. **PAGE B1**

Old Rule Roils Late-Night TV
The F.C.C. is using the “equal time” provision to take aim at hosts who seek to have political guests. **PAGE B1**

OBITUARIES A17, 20

Suave and Riveting Opera Star
José van Dam performed for more than 50 years, and had the title role in “St. François d’Assise.” He was 85. **PAGE A20**

NATIONAL A10-16

M.L.K. Landmark Is Revived
The lodge that was the home base for Dr. King’s activism, long considered endangered, will open to visitors. **PAGE A10**



Striking Nurses Reach a Deal
The pact with NewYork-Presbyterian/Columbia Hospital must be ratified by members, the last on strike. **PAGE A13**

SPORTS D1-10

Look, Ma! . . . Or Maybe Don’t.
When your child races headfirst down an ice chute, leaps off ski jumps or performs snowboard tricks in midair, a medal may not be the main thing you’re praying for. **PAGE D1**

Getting the Ball Rolling
With Major League Soccer matches kicking off, champion Inter Miami may be the favorite, but our panel has some other picks and predictions to field about the season ahead. **PAGE D2**

OPINION A18-19

Michelle Goldberg **PAGE A18**



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Bound for the Kennedy Center
As a dove of artists ditched the center after President Trump’s takeover, a tiny Canadian ice skating troupe debated canceling but carries on. **PAGE C1**

